Report on the Surface Web

Version 1.1 · 69 sites in 13 categories, with identifiers and websites

Report · Version 1.1 · British English
6 November 2026

1. Introduction

The Surface Web is the part of the internet that can be found by search engines and accessed by anyone with a browser, without special credentials, specific software or anonymity settings. It brings together the services most people use every day: social networks, news portals, government websites, video platforms, encyclopaedias, games and code repositories.

This is **version 1.1** of the report on the Surface Web of the WebAtlas repository. It updates the list of sites, the identifiers and the addresses, and adds the Games category. Sites are cited in the text by name; the identifiers appear in the catalogue.

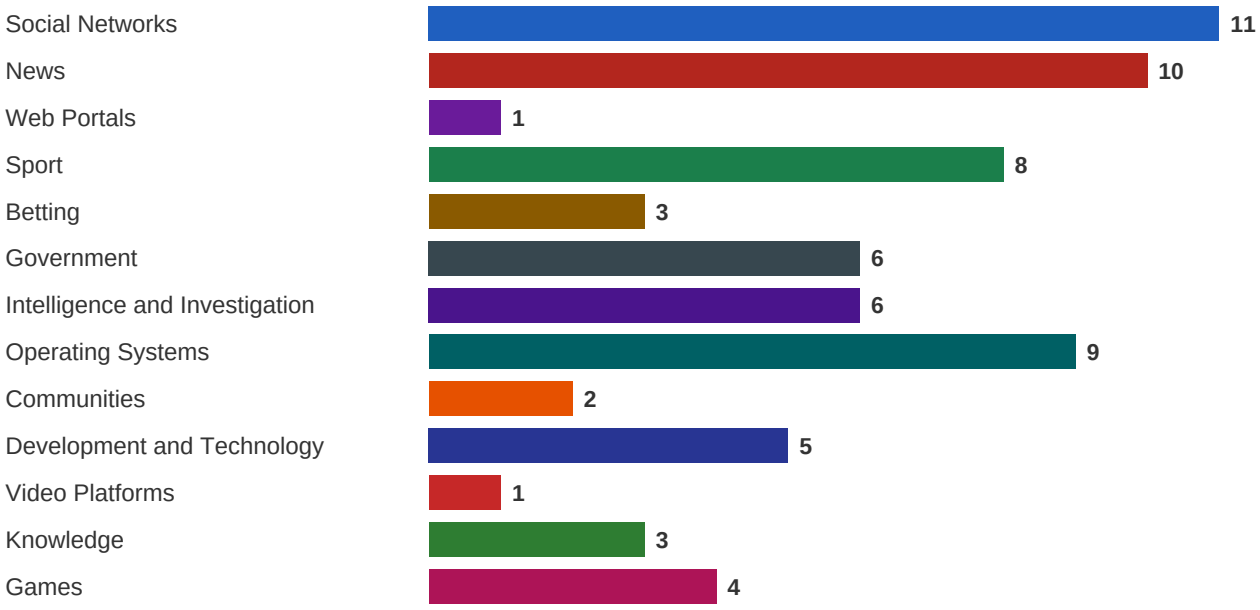
2. What Changed in Version 1.1

Change	Detail
New sites (6)	The Economist and UOL Notícias (News); Poki, 100jogos, Click Jogos and Monou (Games).
New category	Games, with 4 sites.
Sites removed (5)	The Guardian, Al Jazeera and Agência Brasil (News); Europol (Intelligence and Investigation); OpenBSD (Operating Systems).
Names updated (6)	BBC → BBC News; New York Times → The New York Times; Gov.br → Governo Federal do Brasil; Germany Gov → German Federal Government; Finland Gov → Finland Government Services; Interpol → INTERPOL.
Identifiers	Renumbered from WEB-001 to WEB-070, always with three digits: WEB-011, WEB-061 and WEB-062 were normalised. WEB-042 is not used in this version.
Websites	Each site now has its main website address recorded in the catalogue.
Totals	68 → 69 sites; 12 → 13 categories.

Note: the sites removed and the names updated reflect the version 1.1 list supplied by the repository's maintainer. Identifiers follow the **WEB-NNN** pattern, with single, global numbering.

3. Overview

Version 1.1 brings together **69 sites** in **13 categories**. The distribution by category is as follows:



- The largest categories are **Social Networks** (11 sites) and **News** (10), followed by **Operating Systems** (9) and **Sport** (8).
- **Games** debuts with 4 sites, all of free online games.
- Four categories have only 1 or 2 sites: Web Portals, Video Platforms, Communities and, with 3, Betting and Knowledge.

4. Site Catalogue

‡ The website and origin of the Games sites were not supplied and must be confirmed.

4.1 Social Networks · 11 sites

Social networks bring together profiles, posts and interaction between users, and take up a large share of online attention. Centralised, commercial platforms coexist with decentralised, open projects such as Mastodon and Bluesky.

ID	Service	Website	Description
WEB-001	**Facebook**	facebook.com	Profiles, groups, pages and a marketplace; one of the world's largest social networks.
WEB-002	**Instagram**	instagram.com	Photos, short videos, stories and messages; widely used by brands and creators.
WEB-003	**X**	x.com	Formerly Twitter; short posts, real-time news and public debate.
WEB-004	**LinkedIn**	linkedin.com	Careers, recruitment and networking; corporate content.

ID	Service	Website	Description
WEB-005	**TikTok**	tiktok.com	Short videos with algorithmic recommendation; international version launched in 2017.
WEB-006	**Pinterest**	pinterest.com	Visual inspiration for interiors, fashion, cookery and creative projects.
WEB-007	**Snapchat**	snapchat.com	Popularised disappearing messages and augmented-reality filters.
WEB-008	**Threads**	threads.net	Text-based publishing network linked to the Instagram ecosystem.
WEB-009	**Mastodon**	joinmastodon.org	Open source; independent servers that communicate with one another.
WEB-010	**Bluesky**	bsky.app	Built on an open protocol, with more control over feeds and moderation.
WEB-011	**Discord**	discord.com	Servers with text and voice channels; it began among gamers.

4.2 News · 10 sites

Press outlets, broadcasters and agencies, with different funding models, editorial lines and languages. Agencies such as Reuters and Associated Press supply other portals; comparing sources reduces bias and helps identify disinformation.

ID	Service	Website	Description
WEB-012	**BBC News**	bbc.com	International coverage and services in dozens of languages, including Portuguese.
WEB-013	**Folha de S.Paulo**	folha.uol.com.br	One of Brazil's leading newspapers; politics, economy and national coverage.
WEB-014	**The New York Times**	nytimes.com	Influential newspaper, known for investigative reporting and digital subscriptions.
WEB-015	**The Economist** NEW	economist.com	British publication of economic and political analysis, with international coverage.
WEB-016	**G1**	g1.globo.com	National, regional and sports news from Grupo Globo.
WEB-017	**UOL Notícias** NEW	noticias.uol.com.br	National and international news from the UOL portal.
WEB-018	**CNN**	cnn.com	Round-the-clock news coverage and a strong digital presence.
WEB-019	**Reuters**	reuters.com	Global agency, a benchmark for financial information; supplies other outlets.
WEB-020	**Associated Press**	apnews.com	Distributes news, photographs and video to outlets worldwide.
WEB-021	**Deutsche Welle**	dw.com	Multilingual content, focused on European and global coverage.

4.3 Web Portals · 1 site

A general-purpose portal bringing together news, email, finance and search, in the model that dominated the web before the era of social networks.

ID	Service	Website	Description
WEB-022	**Yahoo**	yahoo.com	Historic portal with news, email, finance and search.

4.4 Sport · 8 sites

Sports media, leagues and federations. Federations are the official source for rules, calendars and results.

ID	Service	Website	Description
WEB-023	**ESPN**	espn.com	Portal and TV network with news, results, statistics and broadcasts.
WEB-024	**Olympics**	olympics.com	Official site of the Games: athletes, sports, history and results.
WEB-025	**UFC**	ufc.com	Events, rankings and content on mixed martial arts fighters.
WEB-026	**FIFA**	fifa.com	Football's governing body; organises the World Cup and regulates the sport.
WEB-027	**Formula 1**	formula1.com	Calendar, results, teams and broadcasts for motor racing.
WEB-028	**NBA**	nba.com	US basketball league; games, statistics and team content.
WEB-029	**IBJJF**	ibjjf.com	International Brazilian jiu-jitsu federation; championships, rankings and rules.
WEB-030	**IJF**	ijf.org	International judo federation; world circuit and the sport's regulations.

4.5 Betting · 3 sites

Betting companies. They involve financial risk and the potential for addiction; use only operators licensed in your jurisdiction, set limits and be wary of fake sites imitating betting companies.

ID	Service	Website	Description
WEB-031	**Bet365**	bet365.com	Sports betting, casino and in-play betting.
WEB-032	**Betano**	betano.com	Sports betting and casino, with a strong presence in the Brazilian market.
WEB-033	**Betfair**	betfair.com	Users bet against one another, not against the house.

4.6 Government · 6 sites

Official portals for public services, legislation, open data and transparency. Always confirm the official address, since fake public-service sites are widely used in fraud.

ID	Service	Website	Description
WEB-034	**Governo Federal do Brasil**	gov.br	Single portal for federal government services: documents, enquiries and digital identity.
WEB-035	**USA.gov**	usa.gov	Official portal organising access to US federal agencies and services.
WEB-036	**GOV.UK**	gov.uk	Unified British government portal; a benchmark for digital public services.
WEB-037	**Portal da Transparência**	portaldatransparencia.gov.br	Lets users follow public spending, transfers and benefits.
WEB-038	**German Federal Government**	bundesregierung.de	Institutional information and public policy from the German government.
WEB-039	**Finland Government Services**	suomi.fi	Finnish government portal, reflecting the digitalisation of public services.

4.7 Intelligence and Investigation · 6 sites

Security, intelligence and police cooperation bodies. Public content is institutional and informative, and security alerts, such as those from CISA, are useful to professionals and organisations.

ID	Service	Website	Description
WEB-040	**FBI**	fbi.gov	Federal investigations; publishes cases, wanted persons and alerts.
WEB-041	**CIA**	cia.gov	Publishes institutional material and declassified documents.
WEB-043	**INTERPOL**	interpol.int	Cooperation between police forces in many countries; international notices.
WEB-044	**NSA**	nsa.gov	Signals intelligence and information security.
WEB-045	**CISA**	cisa.gov	Protects critical infrastructure and issues vulnerability alerts.
WEB-046	**Polícia Federal**	gov.br/pf	Brazil's federal judicial police, with services, news and a reporting channel.

4.8 Operating Systems · 9 sites

Official sites for downloads, documentation and support of commercial systems and community projects. Always download from the official site and check the checksums or signatures of the images.

ID	Service	Website	Description
WEB-047	**Arch Linux**	archlinux.org	Minimalist and rolling-release, with complete control over configuration.
WEB-048	**Debian**	debian.org	Stable and traditional; the basis of many other distributions, such as Ubuntu.
WEB-049	**Windows**	microsoft.com/windows	The most widely used system on personal computers.
WEB-050	**FreeBSD**	freebsd.org	Not Linux-based; known for networking, performance and a permissive licence.
WEB-051	**Kali Linux**	kali.org	Aimed at penetration testing, with many tools pre-installed.
WEB-052	**Ubuntu**	ubuntu.com	Beginner-friendly; widely used on servers and in the cloud.
WEB-053	**Fedora**	fedoraproject.org	Community-supported and sponsored by Red Hat; recent technologies.
WEB-054	**Linux Mint**	linuxmint.com	Focused on simplicity; a good option for those moving from Windows.
WEB-055	**TempleOS**	templeos.org	Created by a single programmer; became a curiosity of computing culture.

4.9 Communities · 2 sites

User communities, valued for collective intelligence. Because the content is user-generated, it should be checked with care.

ID	Service	Website	Description
WEB-056	**Reddit**	reddit.com	Themed communities (subreddits), with voting and discussion.
WEB-057	**Stack Overflow**	stackoverflow.com	A reference for programming questions.

4.10 Development and Technology · 5 sites

Code, infrastructure and application security: sites that underpin the technical workings of the web.

ID	Service	Website	Description
WEB-058	**GitHub**	github.com	Version control and collaboration on open and private projects.
WEB-059	**Cloudflare**	cloudflare.com	CDN, protection against attacks and DNS services.
WEB-060	**OWASP**	owasp.org	Guides and lists of the main web application security risks.
WEB-061	**Mozilla**	mozilla.org	Behind Firefox; champions the open web and privacy.
WEB-062	**GNU**	gnu.org	Supplied essential tools to Linux systems; defends users' freedom.

4.11 Video Platforms · 1 site

The world's largest video platform, with entertainment, education, music and live streams.

ID	Service	Website	Description
WEB-063	**YouTube**	youtube.com	The largest video platform: entertainment, education, music and live streams.

4.12 Knowledge · 3 sites

A collaborative encyclopaedia, a digital archive and science: a category of preservation and democratisation of knowledge.

ID	Service	Website	Description
WEB-064	**Wikipedia**	wikipedia.org	Free and maintained by volunteers; one of the most consulted sources.
WEB-065	**Internet Archive**	archive.org	Preserves websites, books, audio and video; archives web pages.
WEB-066	**NASA**	nasa.gov	Images, scientific data, mission news and educational material.

4.13 Games · 4 sites

Portals of free online games. Watch for adverts, external links and data collection, especially from minors. ‡ The website and origin of these sites were not supplied and must be confirmed.

ID	Service	Website	Description
WEB-067	**Poki** NEW	poki.com ‡	Portal of free online games that run directly in the browser.
WEB-068	**100jogos** NEW	100jogos.com.br ‡	Brazilian portal of free online games.
WEB-069	**Click Jogos** NEW	clickjogos.uol.com.br ‡	Free online games portal, linked to UOL.
WEB-070	**Monou** NEW	monou.com.br ‡	Portal of free online games in Portuguese.

5. Overall Analysis

Common characteristics of the Surface Web

- **Accessibility**: open access, with no special tools required, and indexing by search engines.
- **Concentration**: a few large companies dominate a considerable share of traffic, especially in social networks and video.
- **Monetisation**: advertising, subscriptions and user data sustain many services.
- **Diversity of models**: private companies, public bodies, non-profit organisations and community projects all coexist.

Main risks

1. **Disinformation**: especially on social networks and open communities.
2. **Phishing and fake sites**: imitations of banks, governments, betting companies, social networks and games portals.
3. **Privacy**: large-scale data collection by commercial platforms, including of minors on games sites.
4. **Addiction and overuse**: linked to social networks, short videos, games and betting.
5. **Data breaches**: any service that requires registration can be a target.

Good practice

- Check the address (URL) and security certificate before entering any data.
- Use strong, unique passwords, with two-factor authentication.
- Cross-check news against more than one reliable source.
- Download software and operating systems only from official websites.
- Review privacy settings regularly, and keep an eye on children's and teenagers' use of games.

6. Limitations

- The descriptions are informative summaries and imply no endorsement.
- Sites change name, address, ownership and the way they work; confirm important details on the official websites.
- The Games sites (‡) have a website and origin to be confirmed.
- The addresses listed are those of the main sites, as supplied by the repository's maintainer.

7. Conclusion

Version 1.1 makes the WebAtlas Surface Web more current and better organised: a revised list, standardised identifiers, recorded addresses and a new games category. It is where most everyday internet use is concentrated and therefore deserves attention in terms of security, privacy and the quality of information.